

Tuesday, 11 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Clear 26° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Clear 29° 15°	MANCHESTER Overcast 29° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 24° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A record 230 people have reportedly crossed the English Channel in a single small boat, according to Home Office figures.

This incident highlights what the Home Office calls the "reckless and dangerous tactics" used by gangs. They are said to be cramming ever greater numbers onto unseaworthy vessels, risking lives.

MIGRATION · UK
- 2

A woman has told the BBC that Travelodge staff gave a domestic abuser a key to her hotel room, allowing him to attack her.

She described her attacker kicking her hotel room door "off its hinges" after reception provided him with the key. It raises serious questions about hotel security protocols for guests.

SAFETY · UK
- 3

The government is bringing forward a ban on 'subscription traps' by three months, as part of new measures to ease living costs.

The Prime Minister is currently on a UK tour, making a series of announcements focused on tackling the cost of living. This move aims to protect consumers from unwanted recurring charges.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

A British couple held in Iran have ended their hunger strike, according to their family.

Craig and Lindsay Foreman had been on hunger strike for 93 and 84 days respectively. Their family has been campaigning for their release, highlighting the difficult conditions they face.

INTERNATIONAL · UK
- 5

Six people have been arrested after a 23-year-old woman was found dead in north London.

Four women and two men were taken into custody following the discovery in Clerkenwell on Thursday. Police investigations are ongoing to establish the circumstances surrounding her death.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Team GB skeleton racer and Olympic gold medallist Tabby Stoecker is the latest star to join the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!**

Tabby announced she was "over the moon" to be taking part in this year's series. We can't wait to see if her sporting prowess translates to the dancefloor!

ON AIR – Do you think her Olympic discipline will give her an edge, or is dancing a completely different beast?

TV · AUTUMN
- 2 Andrea Bocelli is set to perform in Wales for the first time in 22 years, bringing his incredible voice to Cardiff.**

The legendary Italian tenor will grace the stage at the Principality Stadium in May 2027. It's a rare chance for fans to see him live in the UK.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see perform live that you haven't had the chance to yet?

MUSIC · 2027
- 3 A 'spectacular' stage spin-off of Game of Thrones has opened at the home of Shakespeare, receiving rave reviews.**

Theatre critics are calling it a worthy addition to the epic fantasy franchise. Fans of the books and TV series will no doubt be flocking to see it.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of seeing big screen stories adapted for the stage, or do you prefer them to stay separate?

THEATRE · NOW
- 4 Rising London-based singer Kamal has spoken about the 'scary' moment he approached Dave for his debut album.**

Kamal is aiming for "honesty" in his music and TikTok content, and getting a big name like Dave on board is a huge step. Keep an eye out for his debut!

ON AIR – Who's an up-and-coming artist you've discovered recently that you think everyone should hear?

MUSIC · SOON
- 5 MySpace fans are campaigning for its return, hinting at a potential relaunch with a focus on raw, unfiltered content.**

Fans and creators want a revived MySpace to feel personal and not driven by algorithms. It could be a refreshing change from today's social media landscape.

ON AIR – Would you welcome a return to the 'old school' social media feel of MySpace, or have we moved on too much?

DIGITAL · SOON

On the schedule

1 **A consortium including Amazon founder Jeff Bezos is reportedly in advanced talks to buy a significant stake in Liverpool Football Club.**

BBC Sport understands the group is looking to acquire about a 30% stake in the club. This could mean a huge injection of capital and change for the Reds.

ON AIR – Do you think more big-name billionaires getting involved in football is a good thing for the sport?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **The European Athletics Championships are underway in Birmingham this week, running until the 16th of August.**

It's a fantastic opportunity to see some of the continent's top athletes compete right here in the UK. There's a full timetable of events including track and field.

ON AIR – Are you heading to any of the events, or will you be watching from home? Which sport are you most looking forward to?
ATHLETICS · UK

3 **Everton and Crystal Palace have agreed a swap deal involving wingers Dwight McNeil and Brennan Johnson.**

McNeil is set to join Palace, while Wales international Johnson will move to Goodison Park. It's an interesting move for both clubs ahead of the new season.

ON AIR – Which club do you think has got the better end of this swap deal?
FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Jose Mourinho has revealed he actually agreed to replace Sir Alex Ferguson at Manchester United back in 2013.**

In a new documentary, Mourinho explains how things could have been very different, with David Moyes ultimately taking the hot seat. It's a fascinating 'what if' moment in football history.

ON AIR – How do you think Manchester United's history might have changed if Mourinho had taken over then?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **England's Charley Hull let slip a late lead at the PIF London Championship, as 17-year-old Anna Huang secured another win.**

Hull was one shot ahead with just two holes to play, but Huang's impressive performance saw her claim her fourth Ladies' European Tour event. A rising star to watch!

ON AIR – Is there anything more exciting in sport than seeing a new young talent emerge and take on the established stars?
GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that the joy of 're-reading a favourite book' is more profound than we often realise.**
Researchers found that revisiting familiar stories can offer a unique form of comfort and even reduce stress, thanks to the brain's appreciation for predictable narratives. It's like a warm hug for your brain, apparently!
- 2 The surprising trend of 'adult colouring books' continues to provide a soothing escape for many.**
Originally thought to be a passing fad, the simple act of choosing colours and staying within the lines has proven to be a mindful activity, helping adults unwind after a busy day. Who knew crayons could be so therapeutic?
- 3 Experts are highlighting the calming benefits of 'watching fish in an aquarium'.**
It turns out the gentle, repetitive movement of fish swimming can lower blood pressure and heart rate, making an aquarium a surprisingly effective stress-buster. Perhaps a trip to the local aquatic shop is in order!
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the simple joy of 'receiving a handwritten letter or card'.**
In our digital age, the tactile experience and personal effort of a physical message stand out, often creating a more memorable and cherished connection. It's a little piece of joy through the letterbox!
- 5 A new report suggests that 'the smell of freshly baked bread' can genuinely boost your mood.**
The comforting aroma is often linked to positive memories and feelings of home, acting as a natural pick-me-up. Perhaps it's time to dust off the bread maker, or just walk past a bakery!
- 6 The unexpected charm of 'collecting old coins or stamps' is captivating a new generation of hobbyists.**
Beyond their historical value, the thrill of the hunt and the detailed artistry of these tiny treasures are proving to be a surprisingly engaging pastime. Every piece tells a story, apparently!
- 7 Researchers are exploring the benefits of 'taking a scenic route' even for everyday journeys.**
Opting for a path with more greenery or interesting views, even if it adds a few minutes, can significantly improve mood and reduce feelings of monotony. It's about enjoying the journey, not just the destination.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our old plastic food containers, even though we know they'll probably never see the light of day again?

ANSWER: HOARDING THEM, JUST IN CASE THEY MIGHT BE USEFUL ONE DAY!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT AN EXACT NUMBER OF TIMES, NO MORE, NO LESS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'childhood nursery rhyme' and it just instantly takes you back to being a little one?

Which nursery rhyme has the strongest nostalgic power for you, and what memories does it bring back?

- We all have those 'little tricks' we use to make a simple household chore just a tiny bit easier, don't we?

What's your ingenious shortcut or clever hack for a mundane task that you swear by?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies can taste with their antennae.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest fish is the *Paedocypris progenetica*, which is less than a centimetre long.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres each year due to geological forces.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called chernozem, found in regions like Ukraine and Russia.
- It is illegal to sing out of tune in Maryland, USA, according to local laws.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- A bolt of lightning is hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.
- The first ever recorded traffic lights were installed in London in 1868.

On this day

Day 223 of the year, 142 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Athracht; Christian Feast Day: Clare of Assisi; Christian Feast Day: Gaugericus; Christian Feast Day: John Henry Newman (Church of England). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — Sarah Clelland, Scottish footballer
- 1965 — Embeth Davidtz, American actress
- 1954 — Joe Jackson, English singer-songwriter and musician
- 1941 — John Ellison, American-Canadian musician and songwriter
- 1958 — Jah Wobble, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1942 — Mike Hugg, English drummer and keyboard player
- 1968 — Sophie Okonedo, British actress
- 1985 — Asher Roth, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 1952 — Hussein bin Talal is proclaimed King of Jordan.
- 1975 — East Timor: Governor Mário Lemos Pires of Portuguese Timor abandons the capital Dili, following a coup by the Timorese Democratic Union (UDT) and the outbreak of civil war between UDT and Fretilin.
- 2003 — NATO takes over command of the peacekeeping force in Afghanistan, marking its first major operation outside Europe in its 54-year-history.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1965 — Race riots (the Watts Riots) begin in the Watts area of Los Angeles, California.
- 1995 — The Russell Hill subway accident in Toronto kills 3 and injures 30, due to a combination of human error and a safety system design flaw.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1984 — "We begin bombing in five minutes": United States President Ronald Reagan, while running for re-election, jokes while preparing to make his weekly Saturday address on National Public Radio.

1942 — Actress Hedy Lamarr and composer George Antheil receive a patent for a Frequency-hopping spread spectrum communication system that later became the basis for modern technologies in wireless telephones, two-way radio communications, and Wi-Fi.

- 2012 — At least 306 people are killed and 3,000 others injured in a pair of earthquakes near Tabriz, Iran.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 224 of the year, 141 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Euplius; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Milan; Christian feast day: Herculanius of Brescia; Christian feast day: Pope Innocent XI. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — Mark Kinsella, Irish footballer and manager
- 1992 — Cara Delevingne, English model and actress
- 1963 — Sir Mix-a-Lot, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1966 — Tobias Ellwood, American-English captain and politician
- 1961 — Roy Hay, English guitarist, keyboard player, and composer
- 1971 — Yvette Nicole Brown, American actress, comedian, and talk show host
- 1954 — Sam J. Jones, American actor
- 1985 — Danny Graham, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1964 — South Africa is banned from the Olympic Games due to the country's racist policies.
- 1981 — The IBM Personal Computer is released.
- 1960 — Echo 1A, NASA's first successful communications satellite, is launched.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Between 15 and 150 unarmed members of the Khudai Khidmatgar movement are killed by Pakistani police.
- 1977 — The Sri Lanka Riots: Targeting the minority Sri Lankan Tamils, begin, less than a month after the United National Party came to power. Over 300 Tamils are killed.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)